Apex Systems

ApexTrial CTMS - Validated clinical operations platform for global sponsors

RFP reference	Issued by	Submission date	Contact
RFP-CTMS-2026-014	Helixpharm Therapeutics (fictional sponsor)	1 October 2026	Priya Raman, Director of Life Sciences Solutions (fictional)

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Apex Systems is pleased to respond to RFP-CTMS-2026-014 issued by Helixpharm Therapeutics (fictional sponsor). We understand that the sponsor operates approximately 40 active studies across 12 countries on a legacy on-premise CTMS supplemented by spreadsheets, and requires a validated, cloud-hosted CTMS integrated with the eTMF, EDC and SAP finance systems, with automated investigator site payments and full migration inside 12 months.

ApexTrial CTMS has been deployed at 14 sponsors and CROs since 2017. Our proposal prioritises integration depth, inspection readiness and data integrity. We are transparent that our delivery timeline is 14 months rather than 12; we explain in section 3 why we consider the additional validation time a lower-risk path for a GxP system of record.

We recognise the sponsor's key risks as: loss of audit trail during migration, payment reconciliation errors between the CTMS and SAP, and inconsistent site activation data across countries. Each is addressed explicitly in this response.

2. Proposed Solution and Implementation Approach

ApexTrial is a multi-tenant SaaS CTMS with a hierarchical data model of Program, Study, Country, Site and Subject. All configuration is metadata-driven, so country-specific regulatory milestones, visit schedules and payment rules are configured without code changes.

Named integrations

- eTMF: bi-directional REST API (OAuth 2.0 client credentials). Site activation documents filed in the CTMS are pushed to the eTMF with TMF Reference Model metadata; eTMF completeness status is returned to the CTMS site record. Sync interval 15 minutes.
- EDC: inbound CDISC ODM 1.3.2 adapter consuming subject enrolment and visit completion events nightly and on demand, driving enrolment dashboards and visit-based payments.
- SAP finance: outbound payment requests via SAP BAPI (BAPI_ACC_DOCUMENT_POST) with vendor master lookup, and inbound payment status via IDoc. Reconciliation report lists every unmatched transaction.
- Identity: SAML 2.0 single sign-on with the sponsor's identity provider; SCIM provisioning.

Reporting

Twenty-two standard reports and dashboards (enrolment vs plan, site activation cycle time, monitoring visit compliance, payment aging) plus a governed self-service reporting layer. All reports carry the Part 11 audit context of the underlying data.

3. Timeline, Team Structure and Milestones

We propose a three-wave migration over 14 months. The additional two months versus the sponsor's target are allocated to a full performance qualification of the SAP payment interface before any live payment is released.

Wave	Scope	Months	Exit criteria
0 - Foundation	Platform provisioning, SSO, IQ, integration design, data mapping	1-3	IQ approved; mapping signed off
1 - Pilot	4 studies in 2 countries; eTMF and EDC live; payments in parallel run	4-7	OQ approved; pilot UAT passed
2 - Scale	Remaining 36 studies migrated in 3 batches; SAP payments live	8-12	PQ approved; legacy read-only
3 - Close	Hypercare, legacy decommission, validation summary report	13-14	VSR signed; handover complete

Team

Engagement director (0.5 FTE), delivery lead (1.0), solution architect (1.0), two integration engineers (2.0), validation lead (1.0) plus two validation analysts during OQ/PQ, data migration lead (1.0), change and training lead (0.5). All named team members have delivered at least two prior CTMS programmes.

Risk register (extract)

- Legacy data quality below expectation - mitigated by two trial migrations before Wave 1.
- SAP change freeze during sponsor year-end - mitigated by scheduling BAPI go-live in month 10.
- Sponsor SME availability - mitigated by a named-backup roster agreed at kick-off.

4. Pricing and Assumptions

Pricing is in US dollars, fixed for the five-year term. Licence is per active study per year, which scales with the sponsor's portfolio rather than headcount.

Item	Year 1	Years 2-5 (each)	5-year total
Subscription licence (40 studies x $11,000)	$440,000	$440,000	$2,200,000
Implementation and migration services	$1,250,000	-	$1,250,000
Validation services (IQ/OQ/PQ, VSR)	$480,000	-	$480,000
Integration build (eTMF, EDC, SAP)	$390,000	-	$390,000
Premium support and hypercare	$120,000	$90,000	$480,000
Total	$2,680,000	$530,000	$4,800,000

- Assumes 40 active studies; additional studies at $11,000 per study per year.
- Assumes sponsor provides eTMF and EDC API credentials and an SAP development client by month 2.
- Travel billed at cost, capped at 5% of services fees.
- Annual licence uplift capped at 3% after year 5.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

ApexTrial is designed and operated as a GxP system of record. Every create, update and delete on regulated data records who, what, when and why in a tamper-evident audit trail that is retained for the life of the record plus 25 years.

- 21 CFR Part 11 and EU Annex 11: electronic signatures with meaning, re-authentication at signing, full audit trail, and a maintained requirements traceability matrix delivered with the validation package.
- Validation package: IQ, OQ and PQ protocols and executed reports, requirements traceability matrix, validation summary report. Sponsor retains the right to witness OQ execution.
- ISO 27001:2022 certified (fictional certificate AX-27001-2024-118) and SOC 2 Type II report issued annually.

- GDPR: EU customer data hosted in Frankfurt with a Dublin replica; US data in Virginia with an Oregon replica. Data residency is selected per study. Standard contractual clauses and a data processing agreement are provided.
- HIPAA-aligned safeguards for any US subject identifiers; subject data is pseudonymised at the EDC boundary.
- Role-based access with segregation of duties between payment requester and approver; quarterly access reviews delivered to the sponsor.
- Encryption in transit (TLS 1.2+) and at rest (AES-256); annual third-party penetration test with remediation evidence available under NDA.

6. Support Model, Relevant Experience and References

Support

Severity	Definition	Response	Restore target
P1	System unavailable or regulated data at risk	15 minutes, 24x7	4 hours
P2	Major function degraded, workaround exists	1 hour, 24x7	1 business day
P3	Minor defect or question	4 business hours	5 business days

Hypercare of 10 weeks after each wave with a named support lead on site two days per week. Service availability commitment of 99.9% measured monthly, with service credits.

Experience and references (fictional)

- Northwind Biologics - global CTMS replacement, 55 studies, 18 countries, 2022-2023.
- Cerulean Pharma - CTMS with SAP payment integration, 30 studies, 2021.
- Halden Therapeutics - CTMS and eTMF integration programme, 2023.
- Marlowe Oncology - Phase III portfolio CTMS, inspected by a regulator in 2024 with no findings.
- Stratus CRO - multi-sponsor CTMS, 120 studies, 2019-2020.
- Verdant Vaccines - rapid CTMS deployment in 9 months, 2020.

Six reference contacts can be made available on request. Three references have hosted regulatory inspections of ApexTrial without critical or major findings.